

What is Swarm? tl;dr

UNSTOPPABLE STORAGE

Swarm is a **decentralised storage and communication network** run by peer-to-peer **Bee nodes**. Upload data, get back a **content hash** — a permanent address derived from the bytes themselves. Anyone with the hash can retrieve the content from any Bee node or public gateway.

Storage is bought as **postage stamps**: prepaid batches purchased with **xBZZ** on Gnosis Chain. Batches have a TTL and expire unless topped up. If every batch covering a chunk expires, that content can be pruned.

Homepage



Swarm
ethswarm.org

Docs



Documentation
docs.ethswarm.org

Explorer



SwarmScan
swarmscan.io

What you can build on Swarm

BUILD WITH FREEDOM · SCALE WITHOUT LIMITS

File & media storage

Fixed, content-addressed URLs for any file — images, video, PDFs, datasets, ML artifacts, NFT assets.

Live video & streaming

Early proof-of-concept work on HLS over Swarm exists — expect to integrate and tune it yourself.

Decentralised websites

Publish a static front-end straight to the network. No server, no CDN, no DNS lock-in.

Chat, comments & messaging

Real-time chat, threaded comments and peer messaging. Real-time delivery needs a GSOC subscription (see back).

Blogs & dashboards

Stable URLs whose contents update via feeds. Personal blogs, public dashboards, status pages.

dApp front-ends

Host a static front-end for an Ethereum dApp on Swarm. On-chain contracts with content-addressed UI for a fully decentralised stack.

What Swarm is *not*

- **Not a database.** Opaque blobs addressed by hash — no queries, no indexing, no search. Model structure in the app layer.
- **Not permanent without payment.** Content lives only while a valid postage stamp covers its chunks.
- **Not instantly consistent.** Uploads propagate asynchronously. `deferred:true` (default) returns once data is pushed; `deferred:false` waits for read-back.
- **Not free to write.** Every upload needs a stamp funded with xBZZ. Reads have a small free tier on gateways.
- **Not a smart-contract platform.** It stores data, it does not execute code. Complements Ethereum, does not replace it.

Limitations & gotchas

- **Stamp batch expiry.** Past expiry, chunks become eligible for pruning — not deleted instantly, but can vanish. Monitor and top up.
- **Dynamic pricing.** Stamp cost tracks a price that can rise — top up so batches outlast your needs.
- **Ultra-light nodes can't upload.** Writing needs at least a light node with funds.
- **Feed writes are append-only.** Each index slot writes once; always resolve the current index before writing.
- **Capacity & lifetime are non-deterministic.** Both depend on chunking and dynamic pricing — monitor and top up.

QUICKSTART FOR SWARM DEVELOPMENT

THE RECOMMENDED WAY TO START · ~5 MIN

1 Install Claude Code

MACOS / LINUX / WSL

```
$ curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

WINDOWS · POWERSHELL

```
$ irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

Docs: code.claude.com/docs

2 Add the Swarm skills

LOG IN TO CLAUDE, THEN CLONE & OPEN

```
$ claude # sign in via browser (OAuth)
```

```
$ git clone https://github.com/ethersphere/swarm-quickstart-skills.git
```

```
$ cd swarm-quickstart-skills/.claude
$ claude
```

3 Run `/swarm` to set up

Runs a guided setup — checks for an existing node and installs/configures Bee if needed.

↳ Suggested Developer Journey

```
/swarm → /swarm-setup-bee-interactive
→ /swarm-stamps → /swarm-upload-download | /swarm-host-website | /swarm-blog
```

Type `/swarm` anytime for the full menu.

Prefer written docs? → justdeploy.bzz.link

Step-by-step guides for getting started on Swarm — Bee node install, funding, site hosting — with beginner, intermediate and advanced tracks. Mirror: justdeploy.eth.limo

▶ More on the back: developer URLs, examples, network tools, community ▶

Where to go next scan by category · all links stay updated online



SWARM DEVELOPER RESOURCES

docs.ethswarm.org/docs/develop/resources

One curated landing page linking every category below. Bookmark it — links stay updated online, so this printed sheet keeps working.



LEARN

Get Started

your first 30 minutes

- **What is Swarm** /concepts/what-is-swarm
- **Developer intro** /develop/introduction
- **Bee node quick-start** /bee/installation/quick-start
- **Swarm papers** papers.ethswarm.org



SCAN QR → GET-STARTED HUB

Key Concepts

how it actually works

- **DISC** /concepts/DISC
- **Incentives & BZZ** /concepts/incentives/overview
- **Postage stamps** /.../buy-a-stamp-batch
- **Feeds · Manifests · Chunk types**



SCAN QR → DEEP-DIVE ON CONCEPTS

Developer Guides

recipes for common builds

- **Upload & download** /develop/upload-and-download
- **Host a website** /develop/host-your-website
- **Routing · Dynamic content (feeds)**
- **Multi-author blog · Access control (ACT)**



SCAN QR → ALL DEVELOPER GUIDES

EXAMPLES

Publishing & Websites

static sites, blogs, file uploads

- **upload-react** ethersphere/examples-js
- **Simple Blog** ethersphere/examples
- **Basic Static Website** ethersphere/examples



SCAN QR → MORE PUBLISHING EXAMPLES

Streaming

early HLS-over-Swarm work

- **Stream React example** Solar-Punk-Ltd
- **Stream JS library** swarm-stream-js-lib
- **Reference: feeds** /develop/dynamic-content



SCAN QR → STREAMING REPO

Messaging & Chat

PSS & GSOC patterns

- **Chat React example** Solar-Punk-Ltd
- **Chat JS** swarm-chat-js
- **PSS · GSOC** /develop/.../pss · /gsoc



SCAN QR → CHAT REPO

TOOLS

SDKs & APIs

talk to Bee from your code

- **bee-js** bee-js.ethswarm.org
- **Bee HTTP API** docs.ethswarm.org/api
- **swarm-cli · Swarm MCP** ethersphere/swarm-mcp



SCAN QR → BEE-JS DOCS

Gateways & Deploy

ship & inspect

- **Beeport** beeport.ethswarm.org
- **Public gateway** gateway.ethswarm.org
- **Local test network · SwarmScan**



SCAN QR → DEPLOY & GATEWAY

Community & Support

stuck? ask here first

- **Discord** discord.ethswarm.org
- **Bee FAQ** /docs/bee/bee-faq
- **GitHub · Blog** ethersphere · blog.ethswarm.org



SCAN QR → JOIN DISCORD